Tomislav Mesarić

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Butcher and meat counter professional with experience in customer-facing meat retail since 2015 and hands-on butchery since 2019. Skilled in breaking down beef, pork and lamb carcasses, boning, trimming and portioning meat to order, and preparing fresh sausages. Experienced in FIFO stock rotation, HACCP hygiene routines and temperature checks, as well as advising customers on cuts and cooking times.

EXPERIENCE

Butcher, Mesnica Kod Ante (family butcher shop), Zagreb — 2019–present

- Break down 2–3 beef forequarters and 10–12 pork sides per week; bone, trim and portion meat for the counter.
- Prepare four varieties of fresh sausage using the shop's recipes; produce about 40 kg per week during the busy season.
- Developed the shop's lamb merguez recipe and adjusted the ćevapi mix to 70% beef / 30% lamb following customer feedback. The ćevapi won 2nd place at the Zagreb County craft meat fair in 2023.
- Rotate cold-room stock each morning using FIFO, placing older stock at the front.
- Record cold-room (0–4 °C) and display-counter temperature checks twice a day.
- Serve about 120 customers on a Saturday, advising on cuts and cooking times.
- Prepare whole lambs and suckling pigs for spit-roasting events, including a 2024 wedding order for four lambs and two pigs for 180 guests.
- Ran a six-week dry-ageing trial for beef ribs, recording temperature and weight loss; the shop now sells dry-aged rib by pre-order.
- Trained two apprentices in knife handling and cleaning routines.

Counter Assistant, Tržnica Dolac meat hall stall, Zagreb — 2015–2019

- Served customers, weighed and priced orders, operated the till and completed cash-up.
- Cleaned and sanitised slicers, mincers and the counter at closing.
- Created a closing and cleaning checklist for the slicer, mincer, counter and floor drain following a hygiene inspection remark; it remains in use at the stall.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATES

Vocational Certificate: Butcher (3-year programme), Food Trades School Zagreb, 2015
HACCP Basic Food Hygiene Certificate, 2021 (renewed 2024)
Preparing for the Master Butcher exam (majstorski ispit), planned Spring 2027

SKILLS

Carcass breakdown (beef, pork, lamb) · Boning and trimming · Meat cutting and portioning · Fresh sausage making · FIFO stock rotation · Knife sharpening · Mincer and bandsaw operation · Cold-chain temperature checks · HACCP hygiene routines · Customer service and product advice · Cash handling

LANGUAGES

Croatian (native) · English (good) · German (basic)